

Buy 1, get 1 virtually free

Intel has just released the fastest ever Pentium 4 processor, that clocks a cool 3.06 GHz and is the first to feature Hyper-Threading. However, Windows XP is the only Windows OS that can take advantage of this. Hyper-Threading technology should yield between 14 to 26 per cent improvement in performance, claims Intel. The technology 'tricks' the



underlying software into believing that there are in fact two CPUs. The software can't make out the difference, so it works as though there were two actual CPUs. It would mean, for example, that while playing a game, frame rates are slightly lower because of the processing done by the CPU for the soundcard, the

OS and so on. With Hyper-Threading, this overhead will be negligible. Tests by several enthusiast sites on the Internet have revealed that this chip does score very well—in fact, it is not incorrect to call this mock-SMP (Symmetric Multi Processing), a setup where more than one CPU is used. All this is expected to come at an expectedly hefty price and the CPU has already caused an immediate price war with AMD halving prices of its older CPUs.

Hitman 2 publishers apologise

Released last month, *Hitman 2: Silent Assassin*, from the UK-based publisher Eidos, had come under fire from members of the Sikh community for having depicted the religions' adherents as members of an evil cult.

In the final mission, *Hitman 2* features a violent showdown in a gurdwara and the player is encouraged to enter and kill a group of fanatical believers. In a statement

released by the company, Eidos and IO Interactive, the



developers, have stressed that no offence was intended and

has apologised to the Sikh community for the depiction. Eidos claims to have reached an amicable position with the Sikh Coalition and will now edit all offending content.

All the relevant content from the *Hitman 2* official Web site will also be removed and changes will be made to the forthcoming GameCube version of the title, which was scheduled for release early next year.

Don't fight P2P

The last bastion of P2P is under threat—realising that university networks offer students high bandwidth and the opportunity to swap music and movies, the Recording Industry Association of America and the Motion Picture Association of America sent letters to more than 2,000 colleges, warning them that their networks were used to trade illegal file copies. The Electronic Privacy Information Centre (EPIC) sent letters to universities asking them to consider before installing tools to monitor the file swapping networks, as increased network surveillance could dilute the already scarce university resources.

snapshot

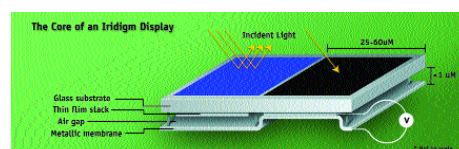
Online music sales drop to **\$545 million** in the first three quarters of 2002, from **\$730 million** in the first three quarters of 2001

Source: ComScore Networks

Looking better

Iridigm, a San Francisco based company has developed a new reflective screen technology using a micro-electromechanical system (MEMS) called an Interferometric Modulator, or iMoD. This device can yield screen brightness as much as three times that of other liquid crys-

tal displays, while consuming less power. The display is made of two conductive plates—one is a thin film stack on a glass substrate, and the other is a metallic membrane suspended over it. The gap between the two is filled with air. The basic principle is the idea of light interference—the same principle found within shimmering butterfly wings that give it the iridescent colours!



Musical directory

Philips may soon help you place a song you can't remember. All you will have to do is dial a number and place your cell phone near the speaker when the track is played. A computer tallies it against a database and sends you a text message with the relevant information. Hashing, the technology used here, breaks the tune into 33

narrow frequency bands and the energy of each band is measured. When a tune is played, the computer cross checks it with the existing database. Philips hopes to have a database of over a 1,00,000 songs and estimates that just three seconds of playtime should give you an accurate match. →



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